

Similarly, if you want to share a folder, right-click on the folder, go to “Sharing and security...”, and check the box “Share this folder on the network”. If you want others on the network to modify the contents on the folder, check the box “Allow network users to change my files”. Click Apply and then OK. Now other systems under the same workgroup should be able to access the printer and the shared folder.

Networked computer works with 10BASE-T network but not with Fast Ethernet: You might face this problem when the computer is located far from the hub. The computer should be within 100 meters of the hub or switch. If the system in the network is further away, you need to install a repeater.

One user can't access network, but others can: This problem arises only when the user has not logged on to the network. To overcome this problem, log off the system and log in again.

6.2 Wireless LANs

Poor performance: The throughput of a wireless LAN (WLAN) is said to be around 54 Mbps for 802.11g and 11 Mbps for 802.11b. If your computer is using the 802.11b standard and the source is using 802.11g, you will not receive speeds in excess of 11 Mbps.

Apart from this simple mismatch, problems with WLANs abound: high utilisation, coverage holes, obstructions, interference and bad access point placement can also affect the speed of the network. WLANs work on the radio frequency and use air as the medium. Since air has a time lag while sending and receiving signals (as compared to copper), it causes high collision rates and retransmission. These collisions result in noise, which in turn affects network speeds. Gadgets such as microwave ovens affect the performance of a WLAN as well. Other objects include cordless phones that run on the 2.4 GHz frequency, as well as other WLANs. If there are other WLANs within the area, change your WLAN to non-conflicting channels. It's important to note here that there are only three